

Of the world's 20 worst cities for air pollution, 14 are in India. In Delhi, thick smog in November 2017 reduced the air quality to the equivalent of smoking 50 cigarettes a day.

Rivers, lakes, and seas

Surface water, groundwater, and the oceans become contaminated by toxic chemicals from industry, from chemical runoff from farmland, from general trash such as plastics, and from human waste.

Some rivers and lakes are so polluted that they cannot support any life at all, deprive communities of freshwater and food, and carry a risk of waterborne diseases, such as polio, cholera, dysentery, and typhoid. The WHO estimates that 2 billion people worldwide are drinking water contaminated with human waste, resulting in the deaths of 500,000 people a year.